Although sometimes you may want to write that `d` attribute yourself, it's more likely that your experience crafting SVG will come in one of three ways: using geometric primitives like circles, rectangles, or polygons; drawing SVG using a vector graphics editor like Adobe Illustrator or Inkscape; or drawing SVG parametrically using hand-written constructors or built-in constructors in D3. Most of this book focuses on using D3 to create SVG, but don't overlook the possibility of creating SVG using an external application or another library and then manipulating them using D3 like we'll do using d3.html in chapter 3.

1.3.4 CSS

CSS are used to style the elements in the DOM. A style sheet can exist as a separate .css file that you include in your HTML page or can be embedded directly in the HTML page. Style sheets refer to an ID, class, or type of element and determine the appearance of that element. The terminology used to define the style is a *CSS selector* and is the same type of selector used in the `d3.select()` syntax. You can set inline styles (that are applied to only a single element) by using `d3.select("#someElement").style("opacity", .5)` to set the opacity of an element to 50%. Let's update your d3ia.html to include a style sheet.

Listing 1.5 A sample web page with a style sheet

```
<!doctype html>
<html>
<script src="d3.v3.min.js" type="text/JavaScript"></script>
<style>
.inactive, .tentative {
  stroke: darkgray;
  stroke-width: 2px;
  stroke-dasharray: 5 5;
}

.tentative {
  opacity: .5;
}

.active {
  stroke: black;
  stroke-width: 4px;
  stroke-dasharray: 1;
}

circle {
  fill: red;
}

rect {
  fill: darkgray;
```